

The chapters in this section address the question of how we humans deal with knowledge—and our preference for the anecdotal over the empirical. [Chapter 1](#) presents the Black Swan as grounded in the story of my own obsession. I will make a central distinction between the two varieties of randomness in [Chapter 3](#). After that, [Chapter 4](#) briefly returns to the Black Swan problem in its original form: how we tend to generalize from what we see. Then I present the three facets of the same Black Swan problem: a) *The error of confirmation*, or how we are likely to undeservedly scorn the virgin part of the library (the tendency to look at what confirms our knowledge, not our ignorance), in [Chapter 5](#); b) *the narrative fallacy*, or how we fool ourselves with stories and anecdotes ([Chapter 6](#)); c) how emotions get in the way of our inference ([Chapter 7](#)); and d) *the problem of silent evidence*, or the tricks history uses to hide Black Swans from us ([Chapter 8](#)). [Chapter 9](#) discusses the lethal fallacy of building knowledge from the world of games.